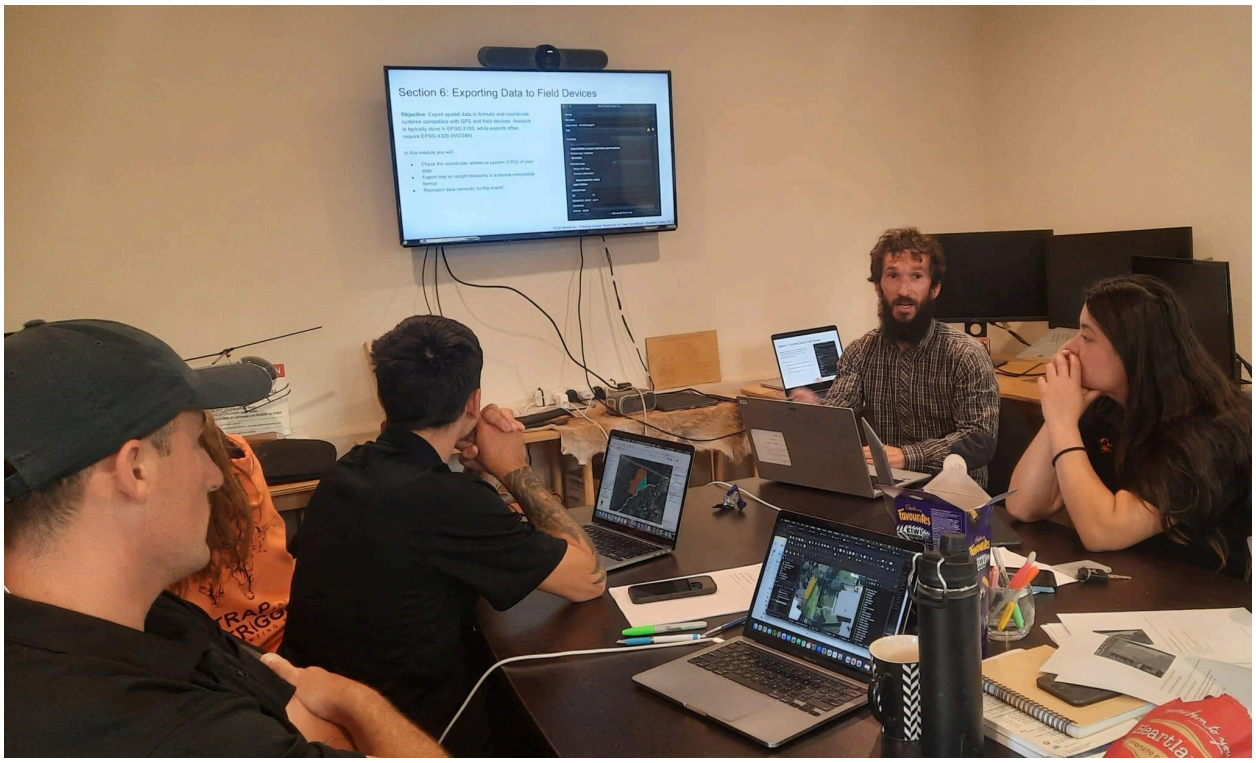
January 2026 (post #2): QGIS workshop for Trap & Trigger Ltd



In a recent hands-on QGIS workshop with the team at Trap and Trigger, we focused on building reusable workflows that teams can apply immediately in day-to-day operational mapping.

The session covered practical tools that help field teams and managers work more confidently with their own data, including:

- importing and organising GPS and survey datasets
- creating clean operational layers for planning and reporting
- exporting spatial outputs for use in other systems and workflows
- understanding basic geoprocessing tools relevant to field operations
- replacing repeated manual steps with reusable tools and automated workflows

Streamlining workflows saves time and helps ensure consistent results. Building tools that teams can understand, reuse, and adapt themselves is central to our philosophy of client ownership and long-term usability.

January 2026 (post #1): Kakī (black stilt) population modelling for the Department of Conservation

Stefan recently had the opportunity to visit the Department of Conservation (DOC)'s kakī (black stilt) captive breeding facility in Twizel. Kakī are one of the world's rarest wading birds, with the remaining wild population restricted to the Mackenzie Basin. Their recovery depends on a highly coordinated programme of captive breeding, chick rearing, habitat management, and carefully planned releases.

Seeing the incubators, newly hatched chicks, and the dedication of the rangers provided important context for the analytical work we have been doing to support the programme.

Our role has been to help strengthen forward planning and long-term decision-making by developing an integrated modelling framework that brings together breeding records, banding data, and kakī re-sightings in the wild. Rather than producing a single prediction, the framework was designed to make uncertainty visible and allow different management options to be explored side-by-side.

Through this work, we were able to:

- Clarify which life stages most influence population recovery
- Explore alternative management options, including changes in release numbers and breeding capacity
- Examine how outcomes may change under different future assumptions
- Identify a key demographic bottleneck currently limiting population growth
- Provide a transparent, reproducible foundation that can be updated as new data become available

One key insight was that increasing release numbers alone has limited impact on long-term recovery unless survival during the first year post-release also improves. This highlights a clear bottleneck where targeted management effort can have the greatest effect.

As a next step, we are now working towards developing an interactive dashboard that will allow the kakī team to explore additional management options as new information becomes available. This will support a more adaptive management approach, enabling strategies to be adjusted over time rather than relying on a static report.

Visiting the facility helped connect the modelling outputs back to the real birds and the day-to-day work that makes kakī recovery possible. Huge respect to the DOC team for their ongoing commitment to this species.

December 2025: Southern Clarity NZ Ltd company launch

We're excited to share the launch of Southern Clarity NZ, a consultancy focused on advanced statistical modelling and decision-support tools for organisations across Aotearoa.

We help teams move beyond static reports and one-off analyses. Many organisations need to make important decisions using complex, evolving datasets, often collected across multiple systems and timeframes. We focus on translating that complexity into clear, defensible evidence that supports real-world decision-making.

Our approach is built around three principles:

- Clarity — making complex models transparent and accessible
- Rigour — applying robust statistical methods grounded in evidence
- Client ownership — ensuring organisations retain full control of their data, code, and tools

The goal is simple: deliver decision-ready insights that can be explored, updated, and reused as new data arrive.

More to come in the new year, including examples of recent modelling and decision-support work.